

QRU • HEALTH



TEACHER GUIDE

QRU Factory Acceptance Test — Understanding Sleep and Rest — Teacher Guide

Foundational • General public
A Sleep & Rest learning product

**QRU Factory Acceptance Test - Understanding
Sleep and Rest - Teacher Guide**

QRU PRESS™

Edition 1

TREASURE STANDARD(TM) CERTIFIED

QRU Teacher Guide - Health

QRU Factory Acceptance Test - Understanding Sleep and Rest - Teacher Guide

Manufactured by QRU Factory(TM). QRU simplifies the path to understanding the truth.

QRU Factory Acceptance Test

Understanding Sleep and Rest - Teacher Guide

Product Type: Teacher Guide

Topic: Health Education / Human Biology / Wellness

Essential Question: Why do humans need sleep, and can rest replace it?

Core Understanding: Sleep is not "doing nothing." Sleep is active biological maintenance. Rest can reduce strain and support recovery, but rest cannot fully replace sufficient, high-quality sleep.

QRU Teacher Promise

This lesson is designed to help students understand sleep without shame, fear, or oversimplification. Students should leave knowing:

- Sleep supports the brain and body in essential ways.
- Rest is valuable, but it is not biologically identical to sleep.
- Sleep needs vary by age and individual circumstance.
- Sleep problems are not moral failures.
- Practical sleep-support strategies can help, and persistent symptoms deserve trusted adult or medical support.

Intended Audience and Adaptability

Recommended Grade Band: Grades 6-12

Best Fit: Middle school health, high school health, advisory, life skills, wellness, psychology, or human biology

Approximate Reading Level: Grades 7-9

Teachers may simplify vocabulary for younger learners or add biological detail for advanced learners.

Adaptation Guidance

| Student Group | Recommended Adaptation |

|---|---|

| Grades 6-8 | Emphasize practical habits, sleep-versus-rest distinctions, and signs for asking an

adult for help. Use visuals and scenarios. |

| Grades 9-12 | Add discussion of circadian rhythms, decision-making, academic performance, drowsy driving, caffeine, work schedules, and mental health. |

| Advanced Biology / Psychology | Extend with sleep stages, memory consolidation, circadian biology, endocrine function, and research interpretation. |

| General Public / Family Education | Use the student handouts, sleep-support plan, and discussion prompts without graded assessment. |

Lesson Snapshot

| Category | Details |

|---|---|

| Estimated Time | 45-60 minutes |

| Lesson Format | Direct instruction, discussion, guided practice, independent reflection, exit assessment |

| Core Skill | Distinguishing sleep, rest, sleep hygiene, and signs that require support |

| Student Product | Personal Sleep-Support Plan |

| Assessment Options | Quick check, scenario sort, exit ticket, short quiz, rubric-based sleep-support plan |

Learning Objectives

By the end of the lesson, students will be able to:

1. Explain why sleep is biologically essential for brain function, immune regulation, cardiovascular health, metabolism, emotional regulation, and physical recovery.
2. Distinguish between sleep and rest, including why rest can help reduce strain but cannot fully replace sleep.
3. Identify risks associated with chronic insufficient sleep, including impaired attention, mood changes, slower reaction time, increased accident risk, and associations with obesity, diabetes, hypertension, cardiovascular disease, and depression.
4. Describe evidence-based sleep hygiene practices, such as keeping a consistent sleep schedule, limiting caffeine near bedtime, reducing evening light and screen exposure, and creating a dark, quiet, comfortable sleep environment.
5. Recognize when support may be needed, including persistent insomnia, excessive daytime sleepiness, loud snoring, gasping during sleep, suspected sleep apnea, or sleep problems that interfere with daily functioning.

6. Create a realistic personal sleep-support plan using one or more healthy sleep strategies appropriate to their life circumstances.

Standards Alignment

Adapt to your district, state, provincial, or national health standards.

| Standard Area | Lesson Connection |

|---|---|

| Health Concepts | Students learn how sleep supports brain function, immune function, heart health, metabolism, emotional regulation, and recovery. |

| Risk and Prevention | Students examine how chronic insufficient sleep is associated with health, safety, mood, and performance risks. |

| Decision-Making | Students evaluate choices that support or interfere with healthy sleep. |

| Self-Management | Students create a practical sleep-support goal or routine. |

| Accessing Valid Resources | Students identify reliable sources and signs that require adult or clinical support. |

| Interpersonal Communication | Students practice non-shaming language when discussing sleep challenges. |

| Personal Health Practices | Students apply evidence-based sleep hygiene strategies to real-life situations. |

Teacher-Facing Health and Sensitivity Notes

1. Avoid shame-based sleep messaging.

Students' sleep may be affected by factors outside their control, including:

- Work schedules
- Caregiving responsibilities
- Shared bedrooms or crowded housing
- Noise, neighborhood safety, or unstable housing
- Family stress or conflict
- Anxiety, depression, trauma, grief, or chronic stress
- Medical conditions, medications, pain, or sleep disorders
- Cultural or religious practices
- Technology access needs or household routines

Use language such as:

"Many people have barriers to sleep. The goal is not to blame ourselves. The goal is to understand what helps and identify one realistic support."

Avoid language such as:

"You just need to be more disciplined."

"People who do not sleep enough are making bad choices."

"Phones are the only reason teens are tired."

2. Sleep needs vary.

Sleep duration recommendations are evidence-based ranges, not personal judgments. Some students may need more or less sleep than peers. However, regularly feeling exhausted, falling asleep unintentionally, or struggling to function may be a sign that support is needed.

3. Correlation is not the same as simple causation.

Research links chronic insufficient sleep with increased risk of obesity, type 2 diabetes, hypertension, cardiovascular disease, depression, accidents, and impaired cognitive performance. These relationships are complex and may involve multiple factors, including stress, genetics, environment, socioeconomic conditions, diet, activity, health conditions, and access to care. Do not present these outcomes as guaranteed or as one-directional simple causation.

Use this phrasing:

"Chronic insufficient sleep is associated with several health risks and may contribute to them, but sleep is one part of a larger health picture."

4. This lesson is educational, not medical advice.

Teachers should not diagnose sleep disorders or provide individualized medical treatment. Encourage students to talk with a trusted adult, school nurse, counselor, or healthcare professional if sleep problems persist or interfere with daily life.

5. Be careful with trauma and safety.

For some students, nighttime may not feel safe or restful. If students disclose unsafe conditions, follow school safeguarding policies. Provide private support pathways rather than requiring public sharing.

Evidence-Based Sleep Duration Recommendations

The American Academy of Sleep Medicine provides the following general recommendations for healthy sleep duration by age.

Age Range	Recommended Sleep Duration per 24 Hours
---	---
4-12 months	12-16 hours, including naps
1-2 years	11-14 hours, including naps
3-5 years	10-13 hours, including naps
6-12 years	9-12 hours
13-18 years	8-10 hours
Adults	7 or more hours is commonly recommended for most adults

Teacher Note: Most students in grades 6-12 fall into the 9-12 hours or 8-10 hours range, depending on age. These are ranges, not rigid rules. Quality, consistency, timing, and individual needs also matter.

Key Vocabulary

Term	Student-Friendly Definition
---	---
Sleep	A biologically essential state that supports brain function, body repair, immune regulation, heart health, metabolism, and emotional balance.
Rest	A period of reduced physical or mental demand that can help the body and mind recover, but does not fully replace sleep.
Sleep hygiene	Healthy habits and environmental choices that support better sleep quality.
Circadian rhythm	The body's internal timing system that helps regulate sleepiness and alertness across the day and night.
Melatonin	A hormone involved in signaling nighttime and sleep readiness. Light exposure can affect melatonin timing.
Sleep quality	How restful and restorative sleep is, including whether a person falls asleep, stays asleep, and wakes feeling reasonably refreshed.
Sleep deprivation	Not getting enough sleep for the body and brain's needs.
Chronic insufficient sleep	Regularly getting less sleep than needed over time.
Insomnia	Persistent trouble falling asleep, staying asleep, or waking too early, especially when it affects daytime functioning.
Sleep apnea	A sleep-related breathing disorder in which breathing repeatedly pauses or becomes shallow during sleep. Loud snoring, gasping, or pauses in breathing can be warning signs.
Restorative	Helping the body or mind recover, rebuild, or function better.

Big Ideas to Emphasize

1. Sleep is active maintenance.

Students may think sleep is "shutting down." Help them understand that sleep supports essential functions, including learning, memory, emotional regulation, immune function, hormone regulation, metabolism, tissue repair, and cardiovascular health.

2. Rest helps, but rest is not the same as sleep.

Rest can calm the body, reduce stress, and lower demand. However, sleep includes biological processes that quiet rest alone does not fully provide.

3. Sleep affects daily safety and performance.

Insufficient sleep can affect focus, memory, mood, reaction time, decision-making, athletic performance, and accident risk.

4. Sleep habits can often be improved.

Students may not control every part of their schedule or environment. Still, many can choose one small, realistic action that supports sleep.

5. Persistent sleep problems deserve support.

If sleep issues continue, interfere with life, or include signs such as loud snoring, gasping, persistent insomnia, or excessive daytime sleepiness, students should seek help from a trusted adult or healthcare professional.

Materials Needed

Teacher Materials

- Projector or board
- Timer
- Lesson slides or board notes
- Scenario cards or printed scenario list
- Answer key
- Exit ticket or quiz
- Optional: sticky notes, chart paper, markers

Student Materials

- Student notes page or notebook
- Sleep-versus-rest comparison chart
- Scenario sorting handout
- Personal Sleep-Support Plan template
- Exit ticket or quiz

Optional Materials

- CDC or AASM sleep duration chart
 - Short video on sleep and the brain from a reputable source
 - Colored cards for "Sleep," "Rest," "Both," and "Needs Support"
 - Anonymous question box
-

Teacher Preparation

Before the lesson:

1. Review the teacher-facing health and sensitivity notes.
2. Decide whether students will discuss sleep habits privately, in pairs, or only through fictional scenarios.
3. Prepare copies of:
 - Sleep-versus-rest comparison chart
 - Scenario sort
 - Personal Sleep-Support Plan
 - Exit ticket or quiz
4. Post or project the essential question:

Why do humans need sleep, and can rest replace it?

5. Prepare a non-shaming class norm:

"We will discuss sleep as a health topic, not as a way to judge anyone's home life, responsibilities, health, or choices."

6. Identify local support pathways:

- School nurse
 - Counselor
 - Trusted adult
 - Family doctor or pediatrician
 - Emergency support procedure if a student reports unsafe conditions
-

Full Lesson Plan

Lesson Sequence Overview

| Lesson Part | Time | Purpose |

|---|---:|---|

| Warm-Up: Rest or Repair? | 5-7 min | Activate prior knowledge and misconception |

| Mini-Lesson: What Sleep Does | 10-12 min | Build core understanding |

| Guided Practice: Sleep vs. Rest Chart | 8-10 min | Compare concepts |

| Discussion: Sleep Needs and Barriers | 7-8 min | Apply sensitivity and real-world thinking |

| Scenario Sort | 8-10 min | Practice decision-making |

| Independent Practice: Sleep-Support Plan | 7-10 min | Personal application |

| Closure and Exit Ticket | 3-5 min | Reinforce and assess |

A. Warm-Up: "Rest or Repair?"

Time: 5-7 minutes

Ask students to respond privately in writing:

"If you lie quietly on the couch for one hour, is that the same as sleeping for one hour? Why or why not?"

Then invite volunteers to share.

Teacher Move

Do not correct every misconception immediately. Use responses to reveal the common idea that rest and sleep are identical.

Transition Statement

"Rest is helpful, and sometimes it is exactly what we need. But today we'll learn why sleep does biological work that rest alone cannot fully replace."

B. Mini-Lesson: What Sleep Does

Time: 10-12 minutes

Present the following core points.

Teaching Point 1: Sleep supports the brain.

During sleep, the brain supports:

- Learning and memory
- Attention and focus
- Emotional regulation
- Decision-making
- Reaction time

Student-Friendly Explanation:

"Sleep helps your brain organize, recover, and prepare for the next day. When sleep is too short or poor quality, it can be harder to focus, remember, manage emotions, and make safe decisions."

Teaching Point 2: Sleep supports the body.

Sleep helps regulate and support:

- Immune function
- Hormones
- Metabolism
- Growth and tissue repair
- Heart and blood vessel health
- Physical recovery

Student-Friendly Explanation:

"Sleep is a maintenance period. Your body is still working, even though you are not consciously active."

Teaching Point 3: Rest is helpful but not identical to sleep.

Examples of rest:

- Sitting quietly
- Stretching
- Deep breathing
- Reading calmly
- Listening to peaceful music
- Taking a break from screens or work
- Lying down without sleeping

Rest can reduce strain and calm the nervous system, but it does not fully replace the brain and body processes that happen during sleep.

Teaching Point 4: Sleep loss affects safety.

Insufficient sleep can increase risk for:

- Slower reaction time
- Mistakes
- Mood changes
- Conflict
- Injuries
- Drowsy driving or accidents

For older students, emphasize:

"Driving while very sleepy can be dangerous because reaction time and attention are impaired."

Teaching Point 5: Chronic insufficient sleep is associated with long-term risks.

Research links chronic insufficient sleep with increased risk of several health concerns, including obesity, type 2 diabetes, hypertension, cardiovascular disease, depression, and impaired cognitive performance.

Important Teacher Language:

"These are associations and possible contributing relationships, not simple guarantees. Sleep is one part of a larger health picture."

C. Guided Practice: Sleep vs. Rest Comparison Chart

Time: 8-10 minutes

Students complete the chart individually or with a partner.

Student Chart

Question	Sleep	Rest
	---	---
Is the person conscious and aware of surroundings?		
Does it reduce physical or mental demand?		
Does it fully replace biological sleep needs?		

| Can it support emotional calm? | | |

| Does it support memory and brain restoration in the same way sleep does? | | |

| Example | | |

Teacher Answer Key

| Question | Sleep | Rest |

|---|---|---|

| Is the person conscious and aware of surroundings? | Usually no or reduced awareness |
Usually yes |

| Does it reduce physical or mental demand? | Yes | Yes |

| Does it fully replace biological sleep needs? | Yes, when sufficient and good quality | No |

| Can it support emotional calm? | Yes | Yes |

| Does it support memory and brain restoration in the same way sleep does? | Yes | No, not fully
|

| Example | Sleeping overnight or taking a needed nap | Sitting quietly, breathing, stretching,
reading calmly |

Discussion Prompt

"Why might rest still be valuable even if it cannot replace sleep?"

Possible student responses:

- It can lower stress.
- It can help someone recover during a busy day.
- It can reduce overstimulation.
- It can help someone prepare for sleep.
- It can be useful when sleep is not immediately possible.

D. Discussion: Sleep Needs, Barriers, and Support

Time: 7-8 minutes

Use one or more prompts. Students may discuss in pairs, write privately, or respond anonymously.

Discussion Prompts

1. Why might two people of the same age need different amounts of sleep?
2. What barriers might make sleep difficult for some students?
3. What is one sleep-support strategy that does not cost money?
4. Why should we avoid judging people for being tired?

5. When should someone ask for help with sleep?

Teacher Notes for Non-Shaming Discussion

If students mention barriers such as caregiving, work, stress, shared bedrooms, noise, or unsafe housing, validate without asking for personal details.

Use responses like:

- "That is a real barrier for many people."
 - "Not everyone has the same control over their sleep environment."
 - "The goal is to identify supports, not blame."
 - "If someone's sleep problem is ongoing or affecting daily life, it is appropriate to ask a trusted adult or health professional for help."
-

E. Guided Practice: Scenario Sort

Time: 8-10 minutes

Students sort each scenario into one of four categories:

1. Sleep
2. Rest
3. Sleep Hygiene Strategy
4. Needs Trusted Adult or Medical Support

Student Scenarios

| | Scenario | Category |

|---:---|---|

| 1 | Maya goes to bed and sleeps from 10:00 p.m. to 6:30 a.m. | |

| 2 | Jordan lies down for 15 minutes after school and listens to calming music without falling asleep. | |

| 3 | Sam stops drinking energy drinks after lunch to make it easier to fall asleep at night. | |

| 4 | Alex snores loudly, gasps during sleep, and feels exhausted most days. | |

| 5 | Priya keeps her room dark and quiet at bedtime when possible. | |

| 6 | Luis closes his laptop 45 minutes before bed and reads a paper book. | |

| 7 | Chen has trouble falling asleep most nights for several weeks and is struggling to stay awake in class. | |

| 8 | A student sits quietly and takes slow breaths before a test. | |

| 9 | Taylor sleeps until late morning on Saturday after a very short sleep week. | |

| 10 | Morgan feels sleepy while driving and pulls over to call for help instead of continuing. | |

Answer Key

| | Correct Category | Explanation |

|---:|---|---|

| 1 | Sleep | Maya is sleeping for a sustained period. |

| 2 | Rest | Jordan is reducing demand but not sleeping. |

| 3 | Sleep Hygiene Strategy | Limiting caffeine later in the day can support sleep. |

| 4 | Needs Trusted Adult or Medical Support | Loud snoring, gasping, and daytime exhaustion may suggest a sleep-related breathing problem. |

| 5 | Sleep Hygiene Strategy | A dark, quiet environment can support sleep quality. |

| 6 | Sleep Hygiene Strategy | Reducing screen use and choosing a calming routine may support sleep. |

| 7 | Needs Trusted Adult or Medical Support | Persistent insomnia and daytime impairment deserve support. |

| 8 | Rest | Breathing quietly can calm the body but does not replace sleep. |

| 9 | Sleep | Taylor is sleeping; teacher may note that "catch-up sleep" can help but does not fully erase repeated sleep loss for everyone. |

| 10 | Needs Trusted Adult or Medical Support / Safety Strategy | Drowsy driving is dangerous. Pulling over and seeking help is a safe choice. |

F. Independent Practice: Personal Sleep-Support Plan

Time: 7-10 minutes

Students complete the template privately. Do not require students to disclose personal sleep schedules publicly.

Personal Sleep-Support Plan Template

Name:

Date:

1. My Current Sleep Reality

Choose one:

- ? I usually get enough sleep.
- ? I sometimes get enough sleep.
- ? I often do not get enough sleep.
- ? I am not sure.

Optional private reflection:

One thing that affects my sleep is:

2. One Sleep-Support Strategy I Could Try

Choose one realistic strategy:

- ? Keep a more consistent bedtime or wake time.
- ? Reduce caffeine later in the day.
- ? Turn off or reduce screens before bed.
- ? Charge my phone away from my bed.
- ? Make my sleep space darker, quieter, or more comfortable when possible.
- ? Create a calming pre-sleep routine.
- ? Use rest breaks during the day when sleep is not possible.
- ? Talk to a trusted adult about sleep difficulties.
- ? Other:

3. My Realistic Goal

Use this frame:

For the next days, I will
because it may help me .

Example:

For the next 5 days, I will stop drinking soda with caffeine after 3:00 p.m. because it may help me fall asleep more easily.

4. Possible Barrier

A barrier that might make this difficult is:

5. My Backup Plan

If that barrier happens, I can:

6. Support I Could Ask For

If I need help, I could talk to:

- ? Parent/caregiver
 - ? Teacher
 - ? School nurse
 - ? Counselor
 - ? Coach
 - ? Doctor or healthcare professional
 - ? Other trusted adult:
-

Examples of Realistic Goals

| Situation | Realistic Goal |

|---|---|

| Student uses phone late at night | "I will put my phone across the room 20 minutes before bed on school nights." |

| Student drinks caffeine late | "I will avoid energy drinks after lunch for one week." |

| Student has a noisy environment | "I will try a fan, white noise, or earplugs if available and safe." |

| Student has many responsibilities | "I will choose one 10-minute rest break after school to reduce stress." |

| Student feels anxious at night | "I will try a calming routine, such as writing worries down or slow breathing, and talk to a trusted adult if it continues." |

| Student has ongoing daytime sleepiness | "I will tell a trusted adult that I am struggling to stay awake during the day." |

G. Closure and Exit Ticket

Time: 3-5 minutes

Ask students to complete the exit ticket.

Exit Ticket

1. In one sentence, explain why sleep is not the same as rest.
2. Name one sleep hygiene strategy.
3. Name one sign that a person should seek trusted adult or medical support.

Exit Ticket Answer Key

Accept reasonable responses.

| Question | Strong Response Includes |

|---|---|

| 1 | Sleep performs biological maintenance that rest alone does not fully replace. |

| 2 | Consistent schedule, limiting caffeine, reducing screens/light before bed, dark/quiet room, calming routine, etc. |

| 3 | Persistent insomnia, excessive daytime sleepiness, loud snoring, gasping, suspected sleep apnea, sleep problems interfering with daily life, drowsy driving, etc. |

Assessment Tools

Option 1: Quick Check Quiz

Student Quiz

1. Which statement best explains sleep?

- A. Sleep is the same as resting quietly.
 - B. Sleep is active biological maintenance for the brain and body.
 - C. Sleep is only needed after exercise.
 - D. Sleep matters only for young children.
-

2. Which is an example of rest, not sleep?

- A. Sleeping from 10:00 p.m. to 6:00 a.m.
 - B. Taking a nap and dreaming.
 - C. Sitting quietly and breathing slowly for five minutes.
 - D. Being asleep during the night.
-

3. Which habit is most likely to support healthy sleep?

- A. Drinking caffeine late at night.
 - B. Keeping a consistent sleep schedule when possible.
 - C. Sleeping with bright lights on every night.
 - D. Doing intense arguments or stressful work right before bed.
-

4. True or False: Rest can be helpful, but it cannot fully replace sufficient, high-quality sleep.

5. True or False: Chronic insufficient sleep guarantees that a person will develop obesity,

diabetes, hypertension, cardiovascular disease, or depression.

6. Name two signs that someone should seek trusted adult or medical support for sleep.

1.

2.

7. Write one realistic sleep-support goal.

Quiz Answer Key

| Question | Answer |

| ---|---|

| 1 | B |

| 2 | C |

| 3 | B |

| 4 | True |

| 5 | False |

| 6 | Accept: persistent insomnia, excessive daytime sleepiness, loud snoring, gasping, pauses in breathing, suspected sleep apnea, drowsy driving, sleep problems affecting school or daily life, nightmares or anxiety interfering with sleep, etc. |

| 7 | Accept realistic goals connected to sleep hygiene or seeking support. |

Option 2: Sleep-Support Plan Rubric

| Criteria | 4 - Strong Mastery | 3 - Proficient | 2 - Developing | 1 - Beginning |

| ---|---|---|---|

| Understanding of Sleep vs. Rest | Clearly explains that rest helps but does not fully replace sleep. | Correctly distinguishes sleep and rest. | Partially distinguishes sleep and rest. | Confuses sleep and rest. |

| Strategy Selection | Chooses a realistic, evidence-aligned strategy appropriate to personal circumstances. | Chooses an appropriate sleep hygiene strategy. | Chooses a vague or only partly relevant strategy. | Strategy is missing or unrelated. |

| Goal Quality | Goal is specific, realistic, time-bound, and personally meaningful. | Goal is realistic and mostly specific. | Goal is general but understandable. | Goal is unclear or unrealistic. |

| Barrier and Backup Plan | Identifies a realistic barrier and practical backup plan. | Identifies a barrier and backup plan. | Barrier or backup plan is incomplete. | Barrier and backup plan are missing. |

| Support Awareness | Identifies appropriate trusted adult or medical support if needed. | Identifies a support person or resource. | Support option is vague. | No support option identified. |

Option 3: Short Constructed Response

Prompt

Explain why rest cannot fully replace sleep. Include at least two functions of sleep and one example of a useful rest activity.

Strong Sample Response

Rest can help a person calm down and reduce physical or mental strain, but it cannot fully replace sleep. Sleep supports memory, emotional regulation, immune function, body repair, and heart health. An example of rest is sitting quietly, stretching, or listening to calming music.

Scoring Guide

| Score | Description |

| ---:--- |

| 3 | Clearly explains the difference, includes at least two sleep functions, and gives a valid rest example. |

| 2 | Explains the basic difference and includes one sleep function or one rest example. |

| 1 | Shows limited understanding or gives an incomplete answer. |

| 0 | Incorrect, unrelated, or blank. |

Memory Reinforcement Activities

Use these during the lesson, at the end, or as review the next day.

1. Retrieval Questions

Ask without notes first; then allow students to check and correct.

1. What is one function of sleep for the brain?
2. What is one function of sleep for the body?

3. Why is rest helpful?
4. Why can rest not fully replace sleep?
5. What is one sleep hygiene strategy?
6. What is one sign that sleep problems may need adult or medical support?

Answer Guide

1. Memory, focus, learning, emotional regulation, decision-making, reaction time.
 2. Immune function, metabolism, heart health, hormone regulation, tissue repair, physical recovery.
 3. It reduces physical or mental demand and can calm the body.
 4. It does not fully provide the biological processes of sleep.
 5. Consistent schedule, less caffeine, reduced screens/light, dark quiet room, calming routine.
 6. Persistent insomnia, excessive daytime sleepiness, loud snoring, gasping, pauses in breathing, drowsy driving, daily impairment.
-

2. "Sleep, Rest, or Both?" Quick Sort

Read each aloud. Students hold up fingers or cards.

- 1 finger = Sleep
- 2 fingers = Rest
- 3 fingers = Both

| Statement | Answer |

|---|---|

| Helps the body recover | Both |

| Fully meets biological sleep needs | Sleep |

| Can be done while awake | Rest |

| Can support emotional regulation | Both |

| Includes reduced awareness of surroundings | Sleep |

| Can include deep breathing | Rest |

| Helps memory consolidation | Sleep |

| Can reduce stress during the day | Rest |

3. Three-Minute Summary

Students write a three-sentence summary:

1. Sleep is important because...
 2. Rest is helpful because...
 3. One way to support sleep is...
-

4. One-Word Review

Ask:

"What is one word you want to remember from today's lesson?"

Students may answer with:

- Maintenance
- Recovery
- Hygiene
- Circadian
- Support
- Rest
- Sleep
- Consistency
- Health
- Help

Have students explain their word in one sentence.

Accessibility and Inclusion Supports

Vocabulary Scaffolds

- Pre-teach key words with visuals.
- Provide sentence frames:
 - "Sleep helps the body by ."
 - "Rest is different from sleep because ."
 - "A person should ask for help when ."
- Allow students to use a bilingual glossary or translation tools.
- Pair vocabulary with icons:
 - Brain = memory/focus
 - Heart = cardiovascular health

- Shield = immune system
 - Clock = circadian rhythm
 - Moon = sleep
 - Chair = rest
-

Discussion Alternatives

Not all students should be required to discuss personal sleep experiences. Offer:

- Private writing
 - Fictional scenarios
 - Anonymous question cards
 - Partner discussion using only examples
 - Drawing or chart completion
 - Digital response form
-

Accommodations for Students With Sleep Disorders or Health Conditions

Some students may have diagnosed or suspected sleep disorders, chronic illness, pain, mental health conditions, medication effects, or neurodivergent sleep patterns.

Support by:

- Avoiding public comparison of sleep hours.
 - Allowing students to write about a fictional person instead of themselves.
 - Accepting goals focused on seeking support rather than changing habits.
 - Avoiding statements that imply sleep problems are caused only by poor choices.
 - Encouraging medical support for persistent or severe symptoms.
 - Following individualized education plans, health plans, or accommodations.
-

Trauma-Informed Considerations

For students affected by trauma, grief, unsafe housing, family conflict, or nighttime anxiety, sleep may be complicated.

Use:

- Predictable lesson structure
- Opt-out choices for personal sharing
- Calm tone
- Nonjudgmental language
- Private support options
- School safeguarding procedures when needed

Avoid:

- Forced disclosure
 - Public sleep tracking
 - Grading students on actual sleep duration
 - Comments that blame families or home environments
-

Equity and Non-Shaming Language

Use this:

"What is one support that might make sleep easier?"

Instead of:

"What are you doing wrong?"

Use this:

"Some barriers are outside a person's control."

Instead of:

"Everyone can sleep enough if they try."

Use this:

"If symptoms continue, it is wise to ask for help."

Instead of:

"Just fix your sleep schedule."

Optional Extension Activities

Extension 1: Sleep Hygiene Myth Check

Students decide whether each statement is accurate.

| Statement | Accurate? | Teacher Note |

|---|---|---|

| "Rest is useless if you cannot sleep." | No | Rest can still reduce strain and support calm. |

| "Caffeine can affect sleep." | Yes | Caffeine can delay sleepiness and reduce sleep quality for some people. |

| "Everyone needs exactly the same amount of sleep." | No | Needs vary by age and individual. |

| "Loud snoring and gasping during sleep can be signs to seek medical support." | Yes | These can be signs of sleep apnea or another breathing issue. |

| "Chronic insufficient sleep is associated with several health risks." | Yes | Present as association/contribution, not guaranteed simple causation. |

Extension 2: Sleep Environment Design

Students design a sleep-supportive environment using realistic constraints.

They may include:

- Reduced light
 - Lower noise when possible
 - Comfortable temperature
 - Safe charging location for devices
 - Calming routine
 - Shared-room strategies
 - Low-cost options
-

Extension 3: Media Literacy Check

Students evaluate a social media post or advertisement about sleep.

Questions:

1. What claim is being made?
 2. Is the claim supported by evidence?
 3. Is the source credible?
 4. Does it promise a quick cure?
 5. Would someone with persistent symptoms still need professional support?
-

Teacher Board Notes

Use this concise version for the board or slides.

Essential Question

Why do humans need sleep, and can rest replace it?

Core Answer

Sleep is active biological maintenance. Rest helps reduce strain, but it cannot fully replace sleep.

Sleep Supports

- Brain function
- Memory and learning
- Emotional regulation
- Immune function
- Heart health
- Metabolism
- Physical recovery
- Safety and reaction time

Rest Supports

- Calm
- Lower stress
- Reduced physical or mental demand
- Recovery breaks

Sleep Hygiene Examples

- Consistent schedule when possible
- Reduce caffeine later in the day
- Reduce bright light and screens near bedtime
- Keep sleep space dark, quiet, and comfortable when possible
- Create a calming routine
- Ask for help when problems persist

Ask for Support If

- Trouble sleeping lasts for weeks
 - Daytime sleepiness interferes with life
 - Loud snoring, gasping, or breathing pauses occur
 - Sleep problems affect safety, mood, school, or daily functioning
 - Drowsiness occurs while driving
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Family or Caregiver Connection

Optional take-home message:

Today students learned that sleep is active biological maintenance for the brain and body. Rest is helpful, but it cannot fully replace sufficient, high-quality sleep. Students also learned that sleep needs vary and that sleep challenges should not be treated as personal failures. If sleep problems persist, interfere with daily life, or include symptoms such as loud snoring, gasping, or excessive daytime sleepiness, families may wish to consult a healthcare professional.

A realistic sleep-support goal could include a consistent bedtime routine, reducing caffeine later in the day, lowering evening screen brightness, creating a calmer sleep space, or asking for help.

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